

Arista Networks Inc. (ANET)

1Q26 review: Beat and raise, supply constraints weigh on upside and GM%

ANET

12m Price Target: **\$196.00**Price: **\$170.22**Upside: **15.1%**

ANET's 1Q26 results beat and 2026 outlook raised. First, ANET's 1Q26 results beat FactSet consensus across EPS (\$0.87 v. consensus \$0.81) and EBIT margins (47.8% v. consensus 46%). ANET continues to see strong momentum among its AI customers (Cloud & AI Titans and AI & Specialty Providers) across scale-out and scale-across use cases, with product revenue up 37% yoy. ANET should continue to be well-positioned amid data center networking upgrades to 800G and 1.6T (ramping in 2027) given the company's best-of-breed networking products coupled with its robust EOS platform. Second, ANET raised its 2026 guide to 27.7% revenue growth year-over-year in 2026 (v. ~25% prior), largely driven by AI Center revenue (2026 guide raised to \$3.5 bn v. \$3.25 bn prior), with Campus guide unchanged (\$1.25 bn). ANET customer demand is constrained by supply constraints from switching ASICs due to upstream decommits in advanced node capacity (similar to AAPL and CLS). That said, we are encouraged by ANET's continued growth in purchase commitments (\$8.9 bn, +\$2.1 bn qoq), as well as in deferred revenue (+\$826 mn qoq, with short-term deferred +\$907 mn qoq), which reflects the strength of ANET's underlying business demand. Separately, upstream decommits should primarily impact ANET's data center business, with campus products (which rely on more mature nodes) relatively unaffected. Third, ANET reiterated its guide for 2026 gross margins of 62-64%, though it should see growing headwinds from both component cost inflation and business mix, making it more challenging to achieve the high end of that range.

ANET's 1Q26 EPS of \$0.87 beat GSe \$0.85 and FactSet consensus of \$0.81.

■ **ANET's 1Q26 revenue of \$2,709 mn was below GSe \$2,728 mn but beat consensus \$2,617 mn and guidance of \$2.6 bn.**

Product revenue of \$2,311 mn was just above GSe of \$2,298 mn and beat consensus of \$2,215 mn. Services revenue of \$398 mn

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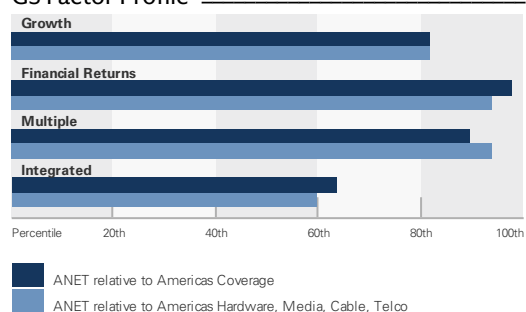
Key Data

Market cap: \$216.8bn
Enterprise value: \$212.1bn
3m ADTV: \$1.1bn
United States
Americas Hardware, Media, Cable, Telco
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (\$ mn) New	9,005.7	11,990.7	15,825.8	19,025.5
Revenue (\$ mn) Old	9,005.7	12,009.8	15,825.8	19,025.5
EBITDA (\$ mn)	4,409.6	5,818.4	8,051.5	9,772.7
EBIT (\$ mn)	4,337.0	5,685.3	7,951.5	9,672.7
EPS (\$) New	2.95	3.77	5.20	6.32
EPS (\$) Old	2.95	3.81	5.24	6.37
P/E (X)	38.7	45.1	32.8	27.0
Dividend yield (%)	—	—	—	—
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	(0.4)	(0.8)	(1.0)	(1.4)
	3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
EPS (\$)	0.87	0.90	0.94	1.05

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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Arista Networks Inc. (ANET)

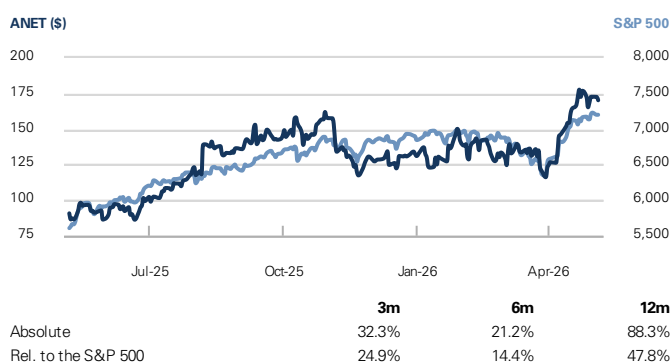
Rating since Mar 6, 2023

Ratios & Valuation

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
P/E (X)	38.7	45.1	32.8	27.0
EV/EBITDA (X)	32.1	35.9	25.3	20.2
EV/sales (X)	15.7	17.4	12.9	10.4
FCF yield (%)	3.0	2.2	2.5	3.3
EV/DACF (X)	38.4	45.3	30.5	24.5
CROCI (%)	385.2	593.3	448.2	298.0
ROE (%)	33.6	33.7	35.3	32.8
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	(0.4)	(0.8)	(1.0)	(1.4)
Net debt/equity (%)	(15.9)	(29.3)	(39.8)	(49.0)
Interest cover (X)	—	—	—	—
Inventory days	233.5	232.5	249.4	258.4
Receivable days	61.3	65.4	64.5	67.3
Days payable outstanding	59.1	60.4	59.9	62.0

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue growth	28.6	33.1	32.0	20.2
EBITDA growth	30.1	31.9	38.4	21.4
EPS growth	29.8	28.0	37.8	21.6
DPS growth	NM	NM	NM	NM
Gross margin	64.6	63.1	64.0	64.0
EBIT margin	48.2	47.4	50.2	50.8

Price Performance

Source: FactSet. Price as of 5 May 2026 close.

Income Statement (\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue	9,005.7	11,990.7	15,825.8	19,025.5
Cost of goods sold	(3,190.3)	(4,420.6)	(5,697.3)	(6,849.2)
SG&A	(523.7)	(624.2)	(717.8)	(825.5)
R&D	(976.6)	(1,268.9)	(1,459.2)	(1,678.1)
Other operating inc./ (exp.)	—	—	—	—
EBITDA	4,409.6	5,818.4	8,051.5	9,772.7
Depreciation & amortization	(72.6)	(133.0)	(100.0)	(100.0)
EBIT	4,337.0	5,685.3	7,951.5	9,672.7
Net interest inc./ (exp.)	—	—	—	—
Income/ (loss) from associates	—	—	—	—
Pre-tax profit	4,719.7	6,096.1	8,351.5	10,072.7
Provision for taxes	(961.1)	(1,305.2)	(1,795.6)	(2,165.6)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Preferred dividends	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	3,758.6	4,790.9	6,555.9	7,907.1
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	3,511.4	4,356.4	6,057.0	7,352.1
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (\$)	2.99	3.82	5.26	6.40
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (\$)	2.95	3.77	5.19	6.31
EPS (ex-ESO exp., dil.) (\$)	2.95	3.77	5.19	6.31
DPS (\$)	—	—	—	—
Div. payout ratio (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Wtd avg shares out. (basic) (mn)	1,258.0	1,254.5	1,246.2	1,236.3
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	1,275.7	1,270.6	1,262.1	1,252.2

Balance Sheet (\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Cash & cash equivalents	1,963.9	4,699.2	8,409.0	13,307.4
Accounts receivable	1,886.9	2,409.2	3,184.3	3,834.9
Inventory	2,247.1	3,384.0	4,401.5	5,294.3
Other current assets	10,289.1	11,463.4	11,463.4	11,463.4
Total current assets	16,387.0	21,955.8	27,458.2	33,900.1
Net PP&E	203.1	327.3	327.3	327.3
Net intangibles	—	—	—	—
Total investments	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other long-term assets	2,858.5	3,164.2	3,244.2	3,324.2
Total assets	19,448.6	25,447.3	31,029.7	37,551.6
Accounts payable	651.7	812.2	1,056.4	1,270.6
Short-term debt	—	—	—	—
Current lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other current liabilities	4,724.8	6,551.7	6,751.7	6,951.7
Total current liabilities	5,376.5	7,363.9	7,808.1	8,222.3
Long-term debt	—	—	—	—
Non-current lease liabilities	0.0	0.0	—	—
Other long-term liabilities	1,701.6	2,036.0	2,105.7	2,178.2
Total long-term liabilities	1,701.6	2,036.0	2,105.7	2,178.2
Total liabilities	7,078.1	9,399.9	9,913.8	10,400.5
Preferred shares	—	—	—	—
Total common equity	12,370.5	16,047.4	21,116.0	27,151.0
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Total liabilities & equity	19,448.6	25,447.3	31,029.7	37,551.6
BVPS (\$)	9.83	12.79	16.94	21.96

Cash Flow (\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net income	3,511.4	4,356.4	6,057.0	7,352.1
D&A add-back	72.6	133.0	100.0	100.0
Minority interest add-back	—	—	—	—
Net (inc)/dec working capital	687.8	375.7	(1,278.7)	(1,056.7)
Others	100.1	124.8	531.6	603.0
Cash flow from operations	4,371.9	4,989.9	5,409.9	6,998.4
Capital expenditures	(119.5)	(241.2)	(100.0)	(100.0)
Acquisitions	(300.0)	—	—	—
Divestitures	—	—	—	—
Others	(3,156.7)	(810.8)	—	—
Cash flow from investing	(3,576.2)	(1,052.0)	(100.0)	(100.0)
Dividends paid	—	—	—	—
Share issuance/(repurchase)	(1,545.4)	(1,170.1)	(1,600.0)	(2,000.0)
Inc/(dec) in debt	—	—	—	—
Others	(48.8)	(32.5)	—	—
Cash flow from financing	(1,594.2)	(1,202.6)	(1,600.0)	(2,000.0)
Total cash flow	(798.5)	2,735.3	3,709.9	4,898.4
Free cash flow	4,252.4	4,748.7	5,309.9	6,898.4
Free cash flow per share (basic) (\$)	3.38	3.79	4.26	5.58

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

missed GSe of \$430 mn and was in-line with consensus of \$398 mn.

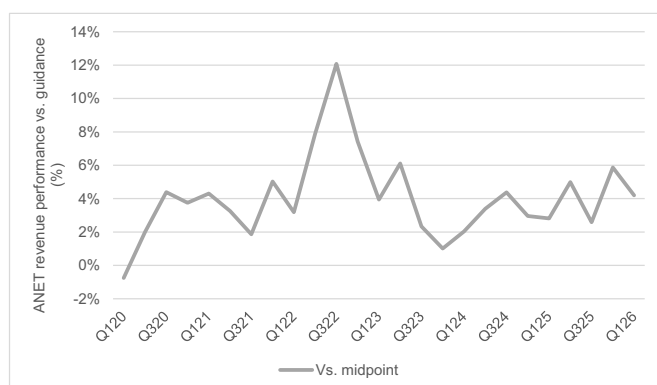
- **Adjusted gross profit of \$1,691 mn was just below GSe \$1,705 mn but beat consensus \$1,637 mn.** Gross margins of 62.4% were largely in line with GSe/consensus of 62.5%/62.5%.
- **Adjusted EBIT of \$1,294 mn was just above GSe \$1,286 mn and beat consensus \$1,204 mn,** with margins of 47.8% beat GSe of 47.1% and consensus of 46.0%.

ANET provided guidance for 2Q26, including (1) revenue of \$2.8 bn (v. consensus of \$2.8 bn); (2) adjusted EBIT margins of 46-47% (v. consensus of ~46.3%); (3) non-GAAP EPS of ~\$0.88 (v. consensus \$0.86); and (4) non-GAAP gross margins between 62-63% (v. 62.6% consensus).

ANET updated its 2026 guidance, including: (1) revenue to grow ~27.7% yoy (v. ~25% yoy prior), with \$1.25 bn in campus revenue (unchanged) and \$3.5 bn in AI fabric revenue (v. \$3.25 bn prior); (2) non-GAAP gross margin of ~62-64% (unchanged); (3) non-GAAP EBIT margins of ~46% (unchanged); and (4) tax rate of ~21.5%.

Exhibit 1: ANET's 1Q26 quarterly revenue beat guidance by 4% v. historical average of 4% since 1Q20.

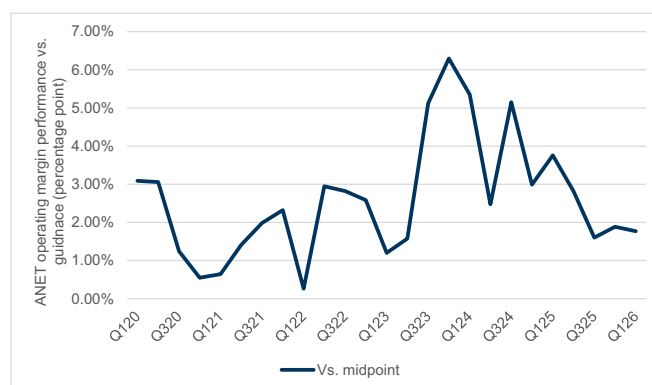
ANET quarterly revenue outperformance v. company guidance (%)



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: ANET's 1Q26 operating margins beat the midpoint of guidance by 177 bps v. historical average of 263 bps (since 1Q20)

ANET quarterly operating margin performance v. company guidance (percentage point delta)



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: ANET actuals vs. estimates

\$ millions, except per-share data

ANET income statement	1Q26				1Q25	
Actuals v Estimates (\$, mn unless otherwise specified)	Actual	Estimate	Δ (\$, mn)	Δ (%)	Actual	yoy Δ (%)
Products	2,311	2,298	13	1%	1,693	37%
Services	398	430	(32)	-8%	312	27%
Total sales	2,709	2,728	(19)	-1%	2,005	35%
Total gross profit (Non-GAAP)	1,691	1,705	(14)	-1%	1,285	32%
Gross Margins	62.4%	62.5%		0%	64.1%	(1.7%)
Total operating expenses (Non-GAAP)	397	419	(22)	-5%	327	21%
Operating income (Non-GAAP)	1,294	1,286	8	1%	957	35%
Operating Margins	47.8%	47.1%		0.6%	47.8%	0%
Interest expense	0	0	0		0	
Other income (loss), net	114	100	14	14%	96	18%
Unrealized gain on note receivable	0	0	0		0	#DIV/0!
Gain (loss) on investment in privately-held companies	(3)	0	(3)		(6)	
Earnings before tax (Non-GAAP)	1,405	1,386	19	1%	1,048	34%
Tax (Non-GAAP)	297	298	(1)	0%	222	34%
Net income (Non-GAAP)	1,108	1,088	20	2%	826	34%
Diluted EPS - GAAP	\$0.80	\$ 0.77	\$ 0.03	4%	\$0.64	26%
Diluted EPS - recurring (excl ESO/amort) (NON GAAP)	\$0.87	\$ 0.85	\$ 0.02	2%	\$0.65	35%
EBITDA	1,302	1,297	5	0%	966	35%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Estimate and price target changes

We lower our 2026/27/28 EPS estimates by 1% on average on higher R&D expense and gross margin headwinds from component cost inflation.

Exhibit 4: ANET estimate changes

\$ millions, except per-share data

ANET income statement	2026E				2027E				2028E			
Estimate changes (\$, mn unless otherwise specified)	New	Old	Δ (\$, mn)	Δ (%)	New	Old	Δ (\$, mn)	Δ (%)	New	Old	Δ (\$, mn)	Δ (%)
Products	10,230	10,117	113	1%	13,503	13,332	171	1%	16,232	16,027	206	1%
Services	1,760	1,893	(133)	-7%	2,323	2,494	(171)	-7%	2,793	2,999	(206)	-7%
Total sales	11,991	12,010	(19)	0%	15,826	15,826	0	0%	19,026	19,026	0	0%
Total gross profit (Non-GAAP)	7,570	7,599	(29)	0%	10,129	10,129	0	0%	12,176	12,176	0	0%
Gross Margins	63.1%	63.3%		(0.1%)	64.0%	64.0%		0.0%	64.0%	64.0%		0.0%
Research & development (Non-GAAP)	1,269	1,193	76	6%	1,459	1,372	87	6%	1,678	1,578	101	6%
Sales & marketing (Non-GAAP)	518	522	(4)	-1%	595	600	(5)	-1%	684	690	(6)	-1%
General & administrative (Non-GAAP)	107	116	(9)	-8%	123	133	(10)	-8%	141	153	(12)	-8%
Intangible asset amortization	33	33	0	0%	33	33	0	0%	33	33	0	0%
Legal expenses	0	0	0		0	0	0		0	0	0	
Total operating expenses (Non-GAAP)	1,885	1,830	54	3%	2,177	2,105	72	3%	2,504	2,421	83	3%
Operating income (Non-GAAP)	5,685	5,769	(83)	-1%	7,952	8,024	(72)	-1%	9,673	9,756	(83)	-1%
Operating Margins	47.4%	48.0%		(0.6%)	50.2%	50.7%		(0.5%)	50.8%	51.3%		(0.4%)
Interest expense	0	0	0		0	0	0		0	0	0	
Other income (loss), net	414	400	14	3%	400	400	0	0%	400	400	0	0%
Unrealized gain on note receivable	0	0	0		0	0	0		0	0	0	
Gain (loss) on investment in privately-held companies	(3)	0	(3)		0	0	0		0	0	0	
Earnings before tax (Non-GAAP)	6,096	6,169	(73)	-1%	8,352	8,424	(72)	-1%	10,073	10,156	(83)	-1%
Tax (Non-GAAP)	1,305	1,326	(21)	-2%	1,796	1,811	(16)	-1%	2,166	2,183	(18)	-1%
Net income (Non-GAAP)	4,791	4,842	(51)	-1%	6,556	6,613	(57)	-1%	7,907	7,972	(65)	-1%
Diluted EPS - GAAP	\$3.43	\$3.45	(\$0.02)	-1%	\$4.80	\$4.84	(\$0.04)	-1%	\$5.87	\$5.92	(\$0.04)	-1%
Diluted EPS - recurring (excl ESO/amort) (NON GAAP)	\$3.77	\$3.81	(\$0.04)	-1%	\$5.20	\$5.24	(\$0.05)	-1%	\$6.32	\$6.37	(\$0.05)	-1%
EBITDA	5,760	5,836	(76)	-1%	7,994	8,066	(72)	-1%	9,715	9,798	(83)	-1%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation. We are Buy-rated on ANET with a 12-month target price of \$196 (v. \$188 prior) based on 36X (unchanged) our NTM+1Y EPS.

Key downside risks include slower cloud capex spending; customer concentration, with META and MSFT representing 16% and 26% of total revenue in 2025 respectively;

competition, including from Cisco, major Chinese providers Huawei & H3C and whitebox switching solutions; margin degradation from investment in enterprise sales force, elevated costs associated with supply chain headwinds; broader pricing pressure from commoditization of networking hardware; inability to execute on enterprise/campus strategy & development of new SD-WAN platform.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

For a more detailed description of how we calculate the GS Factor Profile, please contact your GS representative.

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Quantum

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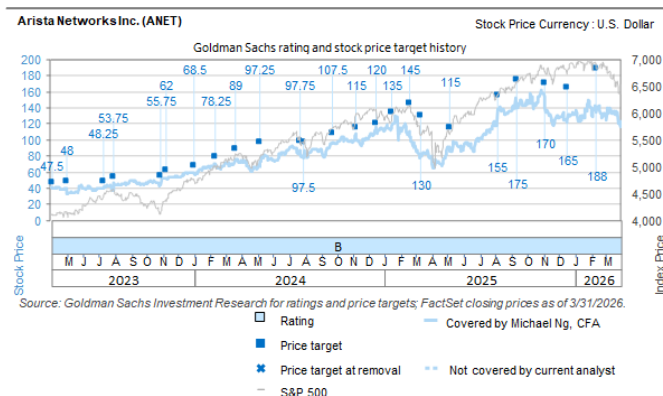
Distribution of ratings/investment banking relationships

Goldman Sachs Investment Research global Equity coverage universe

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	Buy	Hold	Sell		Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	50%	34%	16%		65%	60%	45%

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Price target and rating history chart(s)



The price targets shown should be considered in the context of all prior published Goldman Sachs research, which may or may not have included price targets, as well as developments relating to the company, its industry and financial markets.

Target price history table(s)

Arista Networks Inc. (ANET)

Date of report Target price (\$) Closing price (\$)

13-Feb-26	188.00	141.59
18-Dec-25	165.00	124.62
05-Nov-25	170.00	140.42
12-Sep-25	175.00	139.39
06-Aug-25	155.00	138.78
07-May-25	115.00	86.45
13-Mar-25	130.00	80.14
19-Feb-25	145.00	103.92
16-Jan-25	135.00	118.13
17-Dec-24	120.00	112.95
08-Nov-24	460.00	100.11
23-Sep-24	430.00	96.39
31-Jul-24	390.00	86.64
24-Jul-24	391.00	81.47
08-May-24	389.00	72.92
21-Mar-24	356.00	76.15
13-Feb-24	313.00	66.38
02-Jan-24	274.00	57.89
10-Nov-23	248.00	51.71
31-Oct-23	223.00	50.09
01-Aug-23	215.00	46.40
11-Jul-23	193.00	40.04

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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